

YARA INDIA'S COMMITMENT TO SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURE: A GLIMPSE INTO THE FUTURE

Yara India, a subsidiary of the Norwegian multinational Yara International, has emerged as a spearhead in the field of sustainable agriculture. Since establishing its operations in 2011 in Maharashtra, Yara India has significantly impacted the agricultural landscape through its innovative approaches and deep-rooted connections with the farming community. The recent release of its second Sustainability Report for FY 2023 highlights the company's unwavering dedication to enhancing sustainability and reducing environmental impact.

A Vision for Sustainable Agriculture

The core of Yara India's sustainability efforts lies in its commitment to reducing greenhouse gas emissions. The company has set a bold target to cut emissions by 70,000 tCO2e by 2026. This ambitious goal will be achieved through a combination of improved energy efficiency, the adoption of renewable energy sources, and the implementation of sustainable farming practices. Over the past year, Yara's digital platforms have reached over 4.6 million farmers, providing them with valuable insights and guidance on sustainable agriculture.

Sanjiv Kanwar, Managing Director, Yara South Asia asserts, "In an era where the resource use efficiency is declining, our focus is to ensure nutrition sufficiency to help improve farm productivity and incomes. For the same, Yara offers lower carbon footprint fertiliser portfolio, prioritize practices that restore soil health over time and contribute to move India towards a nature positive food future."

The 5Cs Approach

Yara India's sustainability strategy is built around the 5Cs framework: Commit, Channelize, Care, Concern, and Contribute. This comprehensive approach aligns with the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and addresses critical areas such as resilient governance, efficient resource allocation, environmental stewardship, empathy-driven solutions, and overall societal improvement.

Commit: Upholding Ethical Conduct

At the heart of Yara India's operations is a steadfast commitment to ethical and lawful business conduct. This principle is shared by the company's Board of Directors, senior management, and employees alike. Yara India's governance structures and processes ensure transparency and build trust among stakeholders, forming the foundation for sustainable market leadership. Governance acts as a guiding principle across all efforts under the 5Cs framework.

Channelize: Empowering Farmers

Yara India has made substantial efforts to empower Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs). Partnering with over 200 FPOs across 15 states, including 15 women-led organizations, the company supports approximately 120,000 members of the farming community. By offering premium nutrient products and leveraging global expertise in soil health, crop yield improvement, and water management, Yara helps farmers overcome challenges such as soil degradation, nutrient depletion, and limited market access. These efforts ultimately empower farmers to achieve higher-quality yields and increased profitability.

The 2023 Sustainability Report demonstrates Yara's commitment to creating a more environmentally sound and gender equal agricultural sector in India. This report highlights not just Yara's achievements, but also their ongoing dedication to innovation and environmental responsibility.
May-Elin Stener, Ambassador of Norway to India

Care: Enhancing Energy Efficiency

In its pursuit of sustainability, Yara India has achieved significant milestones in energy efficiency. Innovative initiatives, such as replacing equipment with more energy-efficient alternatives, have resulted in substantial energy savings of 1,246,501 GJ over the past year. Yara's commitment to operational efficiency not only reduces energy consumption but also demonstrates a broader commitment to environmental sustainability. The company's safety performance has also been recognized by the International Fertilizer Association, underscoring its dedication to maintaining high safety standards.

Concern: Promoting Advanced Farming Practices

Yara India employs various methods to promote sustainable and advanced farming practices. Through on-site demonstrations and Yara Knowledge Growth Centres (YKGC), the company has organized over 32,600 agronomy sessions, directly benefiting over 650,000 farmers nationwide. These sessions provide essential knowledge on crop management and modern farming technologies, including the use of drones for fertilizer application.

Contribute: Committing to Community Development

Yara India's commitment to corporate social responsibility (CSR) extends well beyond its business operations. In 2023, the company invested over INR 23 million in community development activities. These initiatives, executed through a dedicated Trust, emphasize Yara's dedication to improving the welfare of the communities it serves. The CSR plan is overseen by six trustees who convene biannually to assess progress, ensuring that Yara's contributions have a meaningful and lasting impact.

Building a Sustainable Future

Founded in 1905 and headquartered in Oslo, Yara International ASA is the world's leading crop nutrition company. With operations in more than 60 countries, Yara's vision of a world without hunger and a planet respected drives its strategy of sustainable value growth. This includes promoting climate-friendly crop nutrition and zero-emission energy solutions, with a focus on creating a nature-positive food future that benefits customers, shareholders, and society at large.

Yara India, as a wholly-owned subsidiary of Yara International ASA, has established a strong presence across 17 states and one Union territory since its inception. Working closely with farmers through Yara Crop Nutrition Centres (YCNC) and FPO initiatives, Yara India has enhanced productivity and ensured high-quality yields. The YCNCs have benefited over 1.2 million farmers, while Yara's digital platforms connect with 5.5 million farmers across India, providing services to 218 FPOs and touching the lives of over 150,000 farmers. Through innovative solutions, strategic partnerships, and a profound sense of responsibility towards the environment and society, Yara India is thus paving the way for a sustainable and inclusive future in agriculture.